

ABDULLAH ALKHULAIWI

IT & Cybersecurity Leader · Infrastructure & Cloud · Microsoft 365 & Azure · CMMC & NIST

Ohio, USA | +1 330-319-4044 | a.alkhulaiwi@gmail.com | linkedin.com/in/alkhulaiwi | alkhulaiwi.github.io

11

years in IT & cybersecurity

35+

incident response engagements

2

clients certified CMMC Level 2

CORE EXPERTISE

- › IT strategy & leadership
- › Managed IT & security services
- › Infrastructure & IT operations
- › Microsoft 365, Entra ID & Intune
- › Azure & Azure Virtual Desktop
- › Windows Server & PowerShell
- › Network & firewall management
- › Vendor & technology selection
- › Disaster recovery & continuity
- › CMMC Level 2 & NIST SP 800-171
- › C3PAO & DIBCAC readiness
- › Incident response & investigations
- › Security baselines (CIS & NIST)
- › SIEM & security monitoring
- › PCI DSS & HIPAA

PLATFORMS

Microsoft 365 · Entra ID · Intune · Azure · AVD · Windows Server · PowerShell · SIEM · EDR · RMM · PSA · Next-gen firewalls · Password management · Backup & DR

CERTIFICATIONS

CMMC Registered Practitioner (RP)

The Cyber AB · Apr 2023

CompTIA Security+ ce

Jun 2025 - Jun 2028

Microsoft Certified: Azure Fundamentals

Sep 2026

Microsoft 365 Certified: Fundamentals

Aug 2023

NIST SP 800-171 CUI

Jan 2024

DoD Mandatory CUI Training

DCSA · Jun 2026

Sophos Certified Architect / Engineer

Apr 2019 / Dec 2018

Keeper MSP Pro

Jul 2026

Cove: Master of Disaster Recovery

Jul 2025

PROFILE

IT and cybersecurity leader with 11 years at a US managed IT and security provider, rising from network security consultant to partner. Runs the technology side of the business end to end: infrastructure, Microsoft 365 and Azure, endpoints, networks, monitoring, and the tools behind them. Owned the technical side of the firm's DIBCAC assessment and C3PAO authorization, guided two defense contractors to CMMC Level 2 certification, and has led 35+ incident response engagements since 2020. Still hands-on in Microsoft 365, Entra ID, Intune, Azure Virtual Desktop, and Windows Server, and just as comfortable walking an executive team through risk, budget, and technology decisions.

EXPERIENCE

Kimmell Cybersecurity and Forensic Services Akron, Ohio · 2015 - Present

Partner, Senior Cybersecurity Manager

Jan 2023 - Present

- Co-led the firm's C3PAO authorization with a fellow partner, owning the technical implementation and evidence while he owned policy. The environment passed its DIBCAC assessment meeting all 110 NIST SP 800-171 requirements.
- Guided two defense contractors to CMMC Level 2 certification as their implementation and remediation lead.
- Built, scaled, and manage the firm's multi-tenant managed SIEM service, from architecture and log source integrations to the SOC dashboards.
- Run IT and security operations across the client base, including RMM, endpoint management, EDR and antivirus policy, and firewall and network management.
- Wrote the firm's security baselines and configuration standards for operating systems, network devices, firewalls, and Microsoft 365, mapped to NIST SP 800-171 and CIS Benchmarks.
- Lead roughly six incident response engagements a year, from containment through forensic analysis, client reporting, and hardening, across cloud servers, endpoints, and Microsoft 365.
- Designed and built multiple Azure Virtual Desktop environments end to end, from architecture through hardening and handover.
- Own technology and security tool selection and purchasing for the firm, evaluating vendors and deciding which platforms get deployed to clients.

Partner, Senior Cybersecurity Consultant

Jan 2017 - Jan 2023

- Delivered cybersecurity assessments and compliance readiness work for PCI DSS, CMMC Level 2, and NIST SP 800-171.
- Designed and secured client environments, including Microsoft 365 migrations, SIEM deployments, DR and business continuity plans, and network security controls.
- Conducted penetration tests, data breach investigations, and security assessments, and delivered security awareness training.

EDUCATION

M.S. Digital Sciences
Digital Systems Telecommunication Networks
Kent State University · May 2014

B.S. Computer Technology & Networking
Cum Laude
Kent State University · Dec 2012

BOARDS & RECOGNITION

Board Member
Goodwill Industries of Akron · 2017 - Present

Board Member
Akron Firestone CLC, Akron Public Schools ·
2018 - Present

Top 10 CIO/CTOs, Northeast Ohio
Crain's Cleveland Business · 2018

Ohio House of Representatives
Honored for academic excellence

LANGUAGES

Arabic Native

English Fluent

Network Security Consultant

Jan 2015 - Dec 2016

- Secured client networks, configured firewalls and IDS/IPS controls, and supported vulnerability assessments and remediation.
- Supported security operations for the 2016 Republican National Convention in Cleveland.

TekGuards Saudi Arabia · 2026 - Present

Founder & CEO

2026 - Present

- Founded a Saudi managed IT and security provider and set its service strategy, operations, and go-to-market.
- Building the company's governance program on the NCA Essential Cybersecurity Controls (ECC-2:2024), with policies covering every business function, not only IT.